Critical thinking

Level 6 · Thinking tools · Worksheet

CREATIVE THINKING WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ question assumptions and dig for root causes
- ☐ spot bias and check sources
- ☐ scrutinise my own reasoning and consider counter-arguments

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A website run by a fizzy-drink company says their drinks help pupils concentrate.

1 Explain why you should be careful using this source. (2 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

The company makes money from selling the drinks, so it may be biased in favour of them ✓. I would check who carried out the research and whether independent, reliable sources such as NHS or university studies agree ✓.

Why marks are not awarded

"It might be wrong."

0 points: doesn't say why or how to check.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

The brief says the school toilets are "always messy".

2 Use the five whys to dig into the root cause. (3 marks)

Sentence starters

One … is …, which means …
Another … is …, so …
Also, … because …

Word bank

building · deeper · reaches · repeatedly · states · removed · vandalism · supervision

Tip: 3 marks = 3 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) What is the purpose of the five whys?
☐ To find the root cause of a problem ☐ To fill time at the start of a project ☐ To choose a colour scheme for an idea ☐ To write the questions for a survey

b) Only reading reviews that agree with your idea is...
☐ Lateral thinking ☐ Confirmation bias ☐ Fail & Fix ☐ Empathy

c) A brand's own website says its trainers are the best. This information may be...
☐ Primary research ☐ A prototype ☐ A persona ☐ Biased

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Critical thinking**	____	**A** Information that leans one way
2. **Five whys**	____	**B** Questioning information and ideas, including your own
3. **Assumption**	____	**C** Ask "why?" repeatedly to find the root cause of a problem
4. **Bias**	____	**D** Something taken for granted without checking

5 Explain what is meant by ‘Confirmation bias’. (2 marks)

6 Explain what is meant by ‘Checking a source’. (2 marks)

Check and reflect
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?